

Word family: **echo / echoes / echoed / echoing**

Base word: echo

Plural: echoes

Verb forms: echo, echoes, echoed, echoing

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞)

Useful constructions/extensions: an echo, hear an echo, echo through a room, echo a sound, echo someone's words, echo an idea, an echo of the past, leave an echo, echo chamber, echoing voice

Your passage contains:

> “Some people pass through your life like background noise, while others **leave an echo**...”

Here, **echo** means:

a lasting trace or effect that remains after the person or original experience is gone.

Meaning in this passage

The sentence contrasts two types of people:

> some people pass through your life and leave little behind

while:

> others leave an echo.

This is metaphorical.

An actual echo is:

> a sound that continues or returns after the original sound.

The passage transfers that idea to human influence:

> the person may no longer be physically present

> but

> their words, values, influence, or memory continue to “reverberate.”

Meaning: A lasting reminder, influence, or trace of something that continues after the original source is gone.

****繁體中文： ** **餘響；留下來的影響 / 痕跡；事情過去後仍持續存在的感受或作用****

****中文翻譯： ****

> “Others leave an echo.”

「有些人會留下****餘響 / 持久的影響****。」

This is the exact passage meaning.

1. ****echo = reflected sound (回聲) — 回音；回聲****

This is the literal core meaning.

****Meaning:**** A sound that is reflected from a surface and heard again after the original sound.

Practice 1

> “We heard an ****echo**** in the cave.”

「我們在洞穴裡聽到****回聲****。」

Practice 2

> “Her voice produced a clear echo.”

「她的聲音產生了清楚的****回音****。」

****echo = 聲音碰到表面後反射回來，再次被聽見的聲音****

2. ****echo = repeated sound (回響) — 回蕩的聲音；回音****

Practice 3

> “The ****echo of footsteps**** filled the hall.”

「腳步的****回響****充滿大廳。」

Practice 4

> “We could hear the echo of laughter.”

「我們能聽見笑聲的**回音**。」

****echo = 原聲之後再次傳回 / 回蕩的聲音****

3. ****echo = verb: sound is reflected (回響 ; 回蕩) — 回聲 ; 回蕩****

A major verb use.

Practice 5

> “Her voice ****echoed through the room****.”

「她的聲音在房間裡****回蕩****。」

Practice 6

> “The shout ****echoed across the valley****.”

「喊聲在山谷中****回響****。」

****echo = 聲音在空間中反射並持續回蕩****

4. ****echo with a sound (充滿回響) — 回蕩著.....****

Practice 7

> “The hall ****echoed with laughter****.”

「大廳裡****回蕩著笑聲****。」

Practice 8

> “The room ****echoed with applause****.”

「房間裡****回蕩著掌聲****。」

****a place echoes with X = 某空間充滿某種聲音的回響****

5. ****echo = repeat a sound (重複某聲音) — 模仿 / 重複聲音****

A transitive verb use.

Practice 9

> “The child **echoed** the sound.”

「孩子**模仿 / 重複**了那個聲音。」

Practice 10

> “The birds seemed to echo each other’s calls.”

「那些鳥似乎在互相**重複彼此的叫聲**。」

echo a sound = 重複、仿效或再次發出相似聲音

6. **echo** = repeat someone’s words (重複別人的話) — 重複；附和

A major figurative verb sense.

Practice 11

> “She **echoed** his words.”

「她**重複**了他的話。」

Practice 12

> “Several students **echoed** the same concern.”

「幾位學生都**表達了相同的擔憂**。」

echo someone’s words = 重複 / 再次表達對方說過的內容

7. **echo** = express the same opinion/idea (呼應；附和) — 呼應；重申

A major abstract extension.

Practice 13

> “Her comments **echoed** my own thoughts.”

「她的評論**呼應了我的想法**。」

Practice 14

> “The report echoes concerns raised earlier.”

「這份報告**呼應了先前提出的憂慮**。」

****echo an idea/opinion = 表達與先前某個觀點非常相似的想法****

8. ****echo = resemble something from the past (呼應過去) — 令人想起；重現****

A major figurative noun/verb branch.

Practice 15

> “The design ****echoes traditional architecture****.”

「這個設計**呼應了傳統建築風格**。」

Practice 16

> “The speech echoed themes from earlier debates.”

「這篇演說**重現 / 呼應了**早期辯論中的一些主題。」

****echo = 在風格、主題、語言或形式上令人想起某個較早的事物****

9. ****an echo of the past (過去的餘韻 / 痕跡) — 過去的回響****

A major figurative expression.

Practice 17

> “The old building feels like ****an echo of the past****.”

「那棟老建築像是**過去留下的回響 / 痕跡**。」

Practice 18

> “The tradition is an echo of an earlier age.”

「這個傳統是早期時代留下的**餘響**。」

****an echo of the past = 過去某種文化、經驗、情緒或風格在現在留下的痕跡****

10. ****echo = lingering memory/effect (餘響；後續影響) — 持續影響；痕跡****

This is the exact figurative branch used in your passage.

Practice 19 — Original

> “Some people pass through your life like background noise, while others ****leave an echo****.”

「有些人像背景聲音般經過你的人生，而有些人會留下****餘響 / 長久影響****。」

Practice 20

> “Her advice left an ****echo**** long after the conversation ended.”

「對話結束很久之後，她的建議仍留下****餘響****。」

Practice 21

> “The experience left an echo in his memory.”

「那段經歷在他的記憶中留下了****餘韻 / 痕跡****。」

****echo = 原來的人、話語或事件已過去，但影響、記憶或感受仍持續存在****

11. ****leave an echo (留下餘響) — 留下持續影響****

Practice 22

> “Good teachers can ****leave an echo**** for years.”

「好老師可以多年留下****持續的影響****。」

Practice 23

> “Her kindness left an echo in the people around her.”

「她的善意在身邊的人心中留下了****長久的餘響****。」

****leave an echo = 某人 / 某事結束後仍留下可感受到的影響或記憶****

This is figurative and somewhat literary.

12. ****echo = faint reminder/traces (微弱痕跡) — 殘留 ; 餘影****

Practice 24

> “There was an ****echo of sadness**** in her voice.”

「她的聲音裡帶著一絲****悲傷的餘韻****。」

Practice 25

> “His smile contained an echo of his father’s expression.”

「他的笑容中有一點****令人想起父親的神情****。」

****an echo of X = 某種情緒、特徵或風格以較淡、較微弱的形式再次出現****

13. ****echo = consequences that continue (後續影響) — 餘波 ; 持續作用****

Practice 26

> “The decision had ****echoes**** for years afterward.”

「這個決定在之後多年仍有****後續影響 / 餘波****。」

Practice 27

> “The conflict still echoes in the community.”

「那場衝突至今仍在社區中留下****持續影響****。」

****echo = 原事件的後果 / 影響在之後仍反覆出現或被感受到****

14. ****echo chamber (回音室 ; 同溫層) — 只重複相同觀點的環境****

A major modern compound.

****Meaning:**** An environment in which people mainly hear opinions similar to their own, reinforcing existing beliefs.

Practice 28

> “Social media can become an ****echo chamber****.”

「社交媒體可能變成一個****同溫層 / 回音室****。」

Practice 29

> “They were trapped in an online echo chamber.”

「他們困在一個網上****意見回音室 / 同溫層****裡。」

****echo chamber = 相同觀點不斷被重複、強化，反對意見很少進入的資訊環境****

This is an established modern figurative use.

15. ****echo chamber = literal acoustic space (回音室) — 產生強回聲的空間****

Practice 30

> “The empty hall felt like an ****echo chamber****.”

「空蕩的大廳像一個****回音室****。」

Practice 31

> “The room acted as an echo chamber.”

「這個房間像****回音室****一樣放大回聲。」

****echo chamber = 聲音容易被反覆反射的空間****

The media/social meaning is metaphorical.

16. ****echoing = full of echoes (回聲不斷的) — 回蕩的****

A common participial adjective.

Practice 32

> “They walked through an **echoing corridor**.”

「他們走過一條**回聲不斷**的走廊。」

Practice 33

> “Her footsteps disappeared down the echoing hall.”

「她的腳步聲消失在**回聲陣陣**的大廳裡。」

echoing = 聲音會明顯反射 / 回蕩的

17. **echoing** = repeating/reinforcing an idea (呼應的) — 呼應；重複

Practice 34

> “He made an **echoing argument** about fairness.”

「他提出了一個**呼應**先前公平觀點的論點。」

Practice 35

> “The article contained echoing themes from the earlier work.”

「這篇文章包含了與較早作品**互相呼應**的主題。」

This adjectival use is less common than the verb:

> echoing earlier ideas.

18. **echo** = technological repeated signal (回波；回音) — 訊號回波

A useful technical meaning.

Practice 36

> “The radar detected an **echo** from the object.”

「雷達偵測到物體反射回來的**回波**。」

Practice 37

> “The signal produced an unwanted echo.”

「訊號產生了不需要的**回波 / 回音**。」

****echo = 聲波、無線電波或其他訊號反射後返回的訊號****

This extends the literal reflection concept beyond ordinary sound.

Important distinction: **echo vs sound**

**sound**

= any audible vibration/noise.

**echo**

= a reflected/repeated sound caused by the original sound.

So:

> every echo is a sound,

but:

> not every sound is an echo.

Important distinction: **echo vs reverberation**

**echo**

= reflected sound heard as a noticeable repetition.

**reverberation**

= repeated reflections blending together so the sound continues.

In everyday English:

> echo

is far more common.

Important distinction: **echo vs repeat**

repeat

= say/do the same thing again.

echo

= repeat or closely reproduce something, often with a sense of reflection or similarity.

> “She repeated his words.”

neutral.

> “She echoed his words.”

often suggests she reproduced/endorsed the same idea.

Important distinction: **echo vs imitate**

imitate

= deliberately copy someone’s sound, behaviour, or style.

echo

= repeat/resemble, sometimes unintentionally.

A design can:

> echo another design

without literally imitating it.

Important distinction: **echo vs agree**

agree

= explicitly hold the same opinion.

echo

= express substantially the same idea or concern.

> “She echoed my concerns.”

means:

> she voiced similar concerns.

It does not necessarily mean formal agreement with every detail.

Important distinction: **echo vs remind**

echo X

= resemble or repeat features of X.

remind someone of X

= cause a person to think of X.

Compare:

> “The design echoes traditional architecture.”

focuses on similarity.

> “The design reminds me of traditional architecture.”

focuses on the observer’s memory.

Important distinction: **echo vs memory**

memory

= remembered representation of an event/person.

echo

figuratively = lingering trace or repeated effect.

Your passage's:

> leave an echo

is more poetic than:

> leave a memory.

It suggests the influence continues to “sound” after the person has passed through that stage of your life.

Important distinction: **echo vs influence**

These are closely connected in your passage.

influence

= the actual effect that shapes someone.

echo

= the lingering trace/reminder of that effect after the original moment.

Mrs. Chan:

> influences you

and her words later:

> echo in your mind.

So:

influence = shaping force

echo = continuing resonance

Important distinction: **echo vs legacy**

echo

= lingering reminder/effect, often subtle or emotional.

****legacy****

= lasting impact, achievement, or consequence left behind over the long term.

****Legacy**** is broader and often more formal.

Important distinction: ****echo vs trace****

****trace****

= small remaining sign that something existed.

****echo****

= a repeated/lingering version of something earlier.

Both can describe remnants, but ****echo**** emphasizes repetition/resonance.

Important distinction: ****an echo of sadness vs sadness****

****sadness****

= direct presence of the emotion.

****an echo of sadness****

= faint remaining hint of sadness.

****Echo of X**** often weakens the intensity and suggests a remnant.

Important distinction: ****leave an echo vs make an impression****

****make an impression****

= strongly affect someone at a particular moment.

****leave an echo****

= continue to have a residual emotional/mental effect afterward.

The second is more literary and emphasizes persistence.

Important distinction: **echo through vs echo with**

echo through + place

= sound travels/reverberates through a space.

> “Her voice echoed through the hall.”

echo with + sound

= a place is filled with a repeated sound.

> “The hall echoed with laughter.”

Different grammatical perspectives.

Important distinction: **echo someone vs echo someone’s words**

echo someone

can mean:

> express the same opinion as that person.

echo someone’s words

more specifically means:

> repeat the wording or idea.

Important distinction: **echo chamber vs community**

An:

> **echo chamber**

is not simply a group of like-minded people.

The key concept is:

> similar ideas are repeatedly reinforced while competing viewpoints are filtered out or rarely encountered.

Important distinction: ****echo chamber vs bubble****

These overlap.

****echo chamber****

emphasizes:

> repeated amplification of the same beliefs.

****bubble****

emphasizes:

> isolation from outside information/perspectives.

An environment can be both.

Important distinction: ****echo = literal vs metaphorical****

Compare:

> “Her voice left an echo in the hall.”

= literal sound reflection.

versus:

> “Her words left an echo in my mind.”

= figurative lasting mental effect.

Your passage uses the second conceptual branch.

Family-extension sweep

The practical **echo** family is compact but semantically rich:

- * **echo — reflected sound** = 回聲 / 回音
- * **echo of footsteps/laughter** = 腳步 / 笑聲的回響
- * **echo — verb: reverberate** = 回蕩 / 回響
- * **echo through a room** = 在空間中回蕩
- * **echo with laughter** = 回蕩著笑聲
- * **echo a sound** = 重複 / 模仿聲音
- * **echo someone's words** = 重複別人的話
- * **echo an idea/opinion** = 呼應 / 重申某觀點
- * **echo a style/theme** = 在風格 / 主題上呼應
- * **an echo of the past** = 過去的餘響 / 痕跡
- * **echo — lingering effect** = 持續影響 / 餘響
- * **leave an echo** = 留下持久痕跡 / 影響
- * **an echo of sadness** = 一絲殘留的悲傷
- * **echo chamber — figurative** = 同溫層 / 資訊回音室
- * **echo chamber — literal** = 回音室
- * **echoing room/corridor** = 回聲不斷的空間
- * **echo — radar/signal** = 回波 / 反射訊號

The main semantic branches are:

- > **reflected sound**
- > **sound reverberating through a place**
- > **repeat someone's words or ideas**
- > **resemble/call back to an earlier style or event**
- > **lingering trace or influence**
- > **technical reflected signal**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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echo — literal sound	原聲碰到表面後反射回來，再次被聽見的聲音
echo — verb	聲音在空間中反射並持續回蕩
echo a sound	重複、模仿或再次發出相似聲音

echo someone's words	重複 / 再次表達某人說過的內容	
echo an idea/opinion	表達與先前某個觀點高度相似的想法；呼應	
echo a style/theme	在風格、主題或形式上令人想起較早的事物	
an echo of the past	過去某種文化、經驗或風格在現在留下的痕跡	
echo — lingering effect	原來的人 / 事件已過去，但影響、感受或記憶仍持續存在	
leave an echo	某人 / 某事結束後仍留下持久、可感受到的影響	
an echo of emotion	某種情緒以較微弱、殘留的形式再次出現	
echo chamber	相同觀點反覆被重複和強化、外部不同意見很少進入的環境	
echoing	充滿明顯回聲 / 聲音不斷回蕩的	
echo — signal	聲波、雷達波等反射後返回的訊號 / 回波	

For your original passage

> “Some people pass through your life like background noise, while others **leave an echo**, and she definitely belonged to the second group.”

The metaphor works in two stages.

First group

> **background noise**

These people are present, but their effect is weak and easily ignored.

Second group

> **leave an echo**

The original person may no longer be physically present in your daily life, but something of them continues:

- * their advice;
- * their voice;
- * their values;
- * their influence;
- * the way they changed your thinking.

That becomes even more important later in your passage:

> “Even now, I can still hear her voice in the back of my mind...”

So the earlier metaphor:

> **leave an echo**

is developed again later.

Her literal voice is not actually echoing.

Instead:

> her words remain mentally present.

Therefore:

****leave an echo = leave a lasting psychological/emotional influence that continues after the original interaction has ended****

The most important learner contrasts are:

> ****hear an echo****

> = 聽到回聲

> ****her voice echoed through the hall****

> = 她的聲音在大廳中回蕩

> ****the hall echoed with laughter****

> = 大廳回蕩著笑聲

> ****echo his words****

> = 重複 / 呼應他的話

> ****echo my concerns****

> = 呼應我的憂慮

> ****the design echoes the past****

> = 設計呼應過去的風格

> ****an echo of sadness****

> = 一絲悲傷的餘韻

> ****an echo of the past****

> = 過去的餘響 / 痕跡

> ****leave an echo****

> = 留下持續影響

> ****echo chamber****

> = 同溫層 / 資訊回音室

So **echo** is much richer than simply:

> **echo = 回聲**

The key semantic map is:

ECHO — sound

→ reflected sound

→ sound reverberates

ECHO — repetition

→ repeat words

→ repeat ideas

ECHO — resemblance

→ reflect an earlier style/theme

ECHO — figurative persistence

→ lingering trace / influence

And in your original passage:

echo = “the lasting mental and emotional resonance left by a person whose words and influence continue long after the original interaction has ended.”